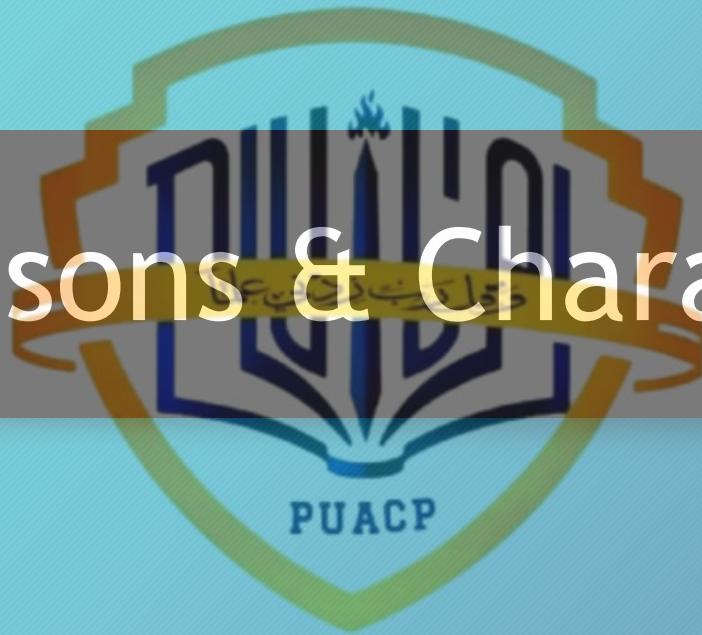


Lecture 2



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Objectives, Reasons & Characteristics



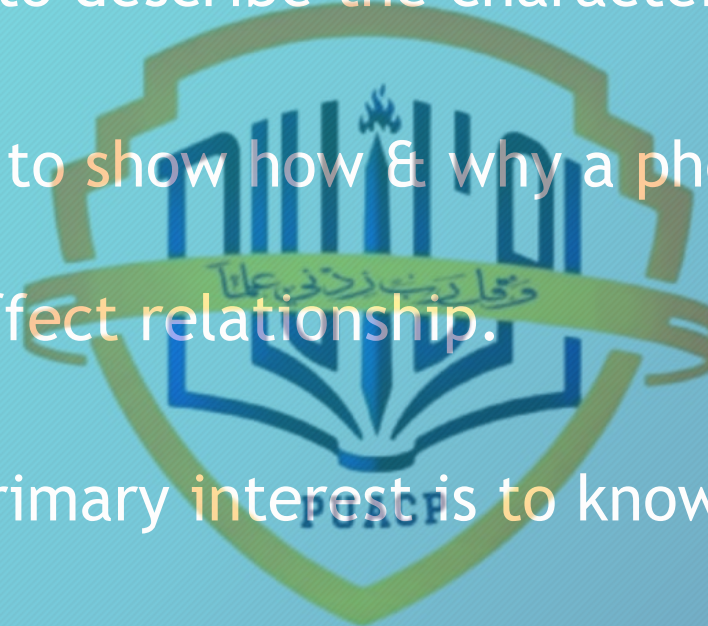
Objectives of Research

There are 5 major objectives of Research

1. Exploration
2. Description
3. Explanation
4. Prediction
5. Influence



1. **Exploration** i.e. tries to generate ideas about something
2. **Description** i.e. wants to describe the characteristics of something
3. **Explanation** i.e. wants to show how & why a phenomena operates or explaining cause and effect relationship.
4. **Prediction** i.e. when primary interest is to know the future events.
5. **Influence** i.e. involves the application of research results to impact the world.



Reasons to learn Research

There are 5 major reasons to learn research

1. To become research literate.
2. Society derives us to research.
3. To improve critical thinking skills.
4. To critically evaluate published research.
5. To design and conduct research in case the need take place.



Characteristics of Research Process:

Research process must have certain characteristics:

1. Controlled
2. Rigorous
3. Systematic
4. Valid and verifiable
5. Empirical
6. Critical

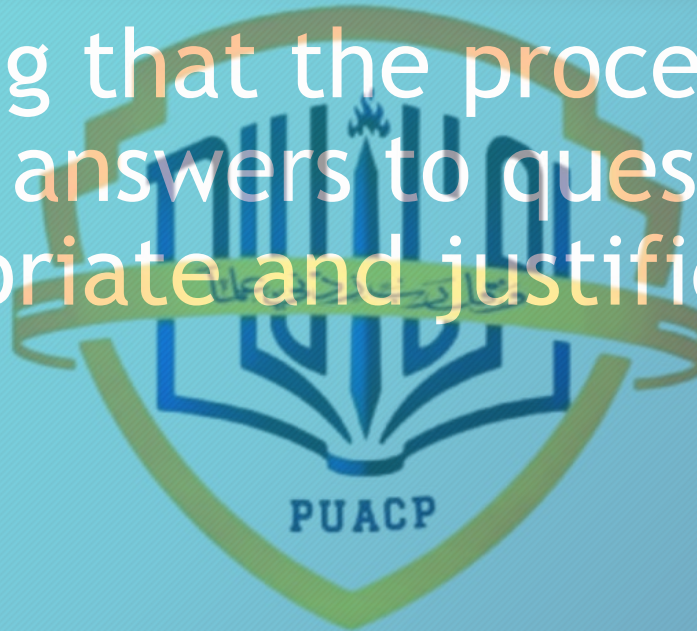


1- Controlled

- It means that in exploring causality in relation to two variables, you set up your study in a way that minimizes the effects of other factors affecting the relationship.
- This can be achieved to a large extent in the physical sciences, as most of the research is done in a laboratory.
- However, in the social sciences it is extremely difficult as research is carried out on issues relating to human beings living in society, where such controls are impossible.

2- Rigorous

- It means ensuring that the procedures followed to find answers to questions are relevant, appropriate and justified.



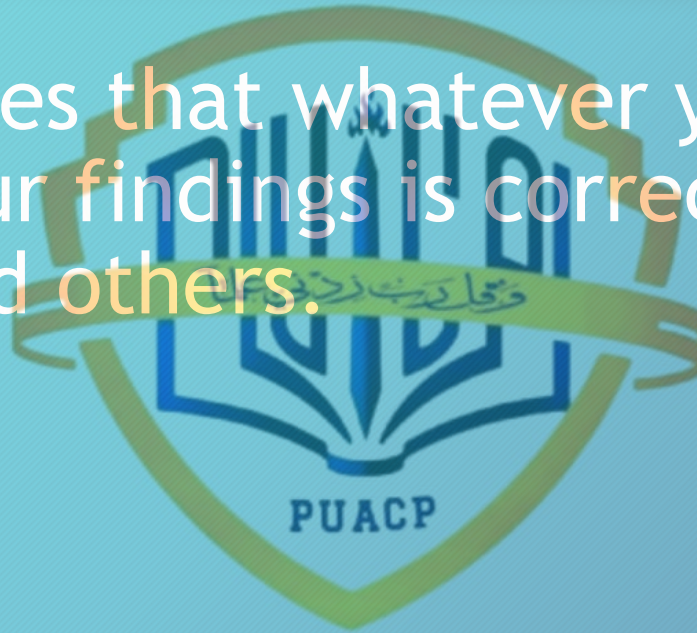
3- Systematic

- This implies that the procedures adopted to undertake an investigation follow a certain logical sequence.
- The different steps cannot be taken in a haphazard way.



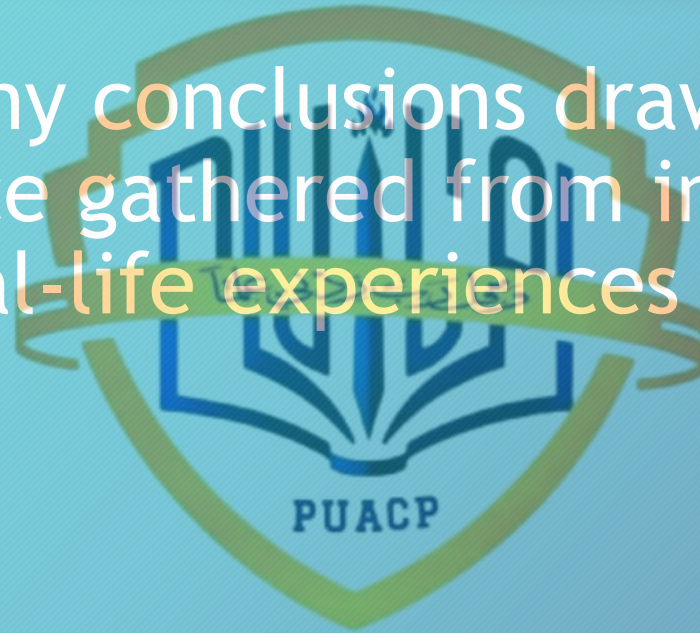
4- Valid and verifiable

- This concept implies that whatever you conclude on the basis of your findings is correct and can be verified by you and others.



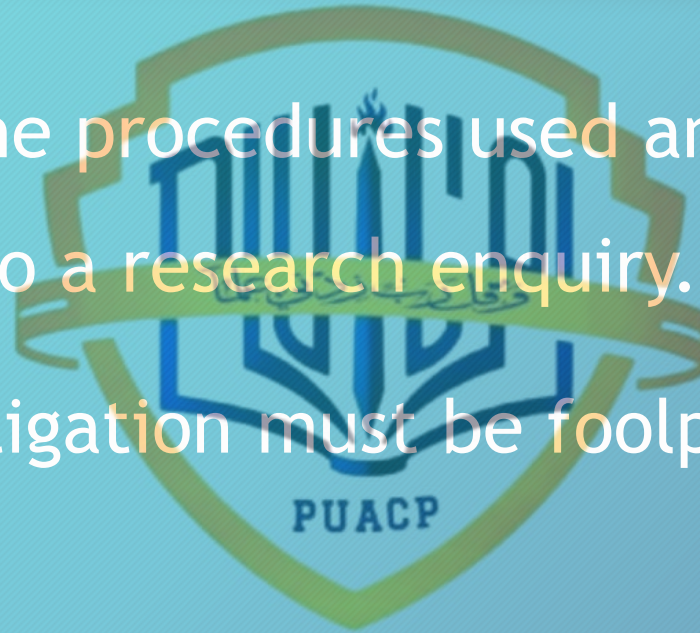
5- Empirical

- This means that any conclusions drawn are based upon hard evidence gathered from information collected from real-life experiences or observations.

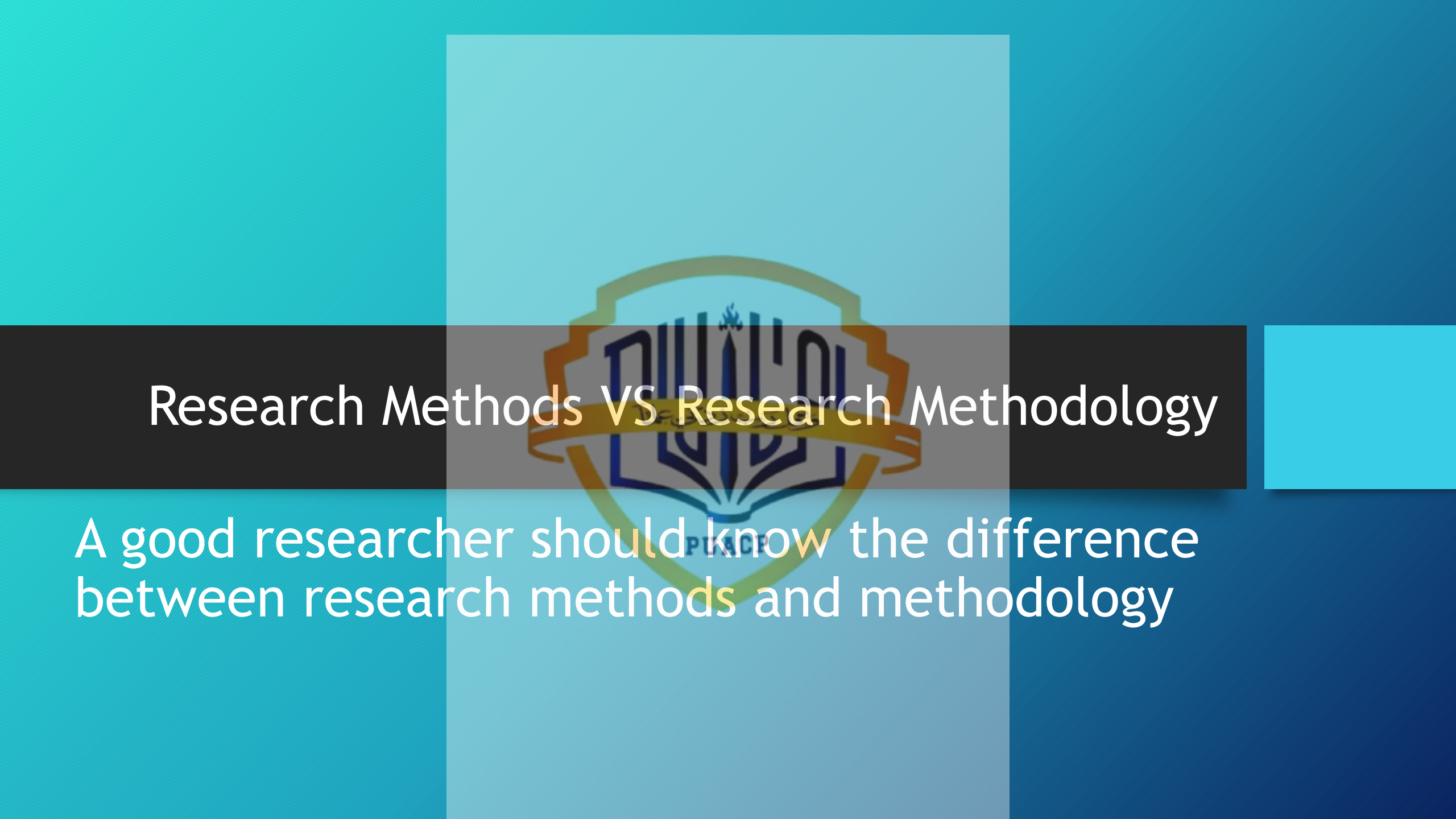


6- Critical

- Critical scrutiny of the procedures used and the methods employed is crucial to a research enquiry.
- The process of investigation must be foolproof and free from any drawbacks.
- The process adopted and the procedures used must be able to withstand critical scrutiny.



Research Methods VS Research Methodology



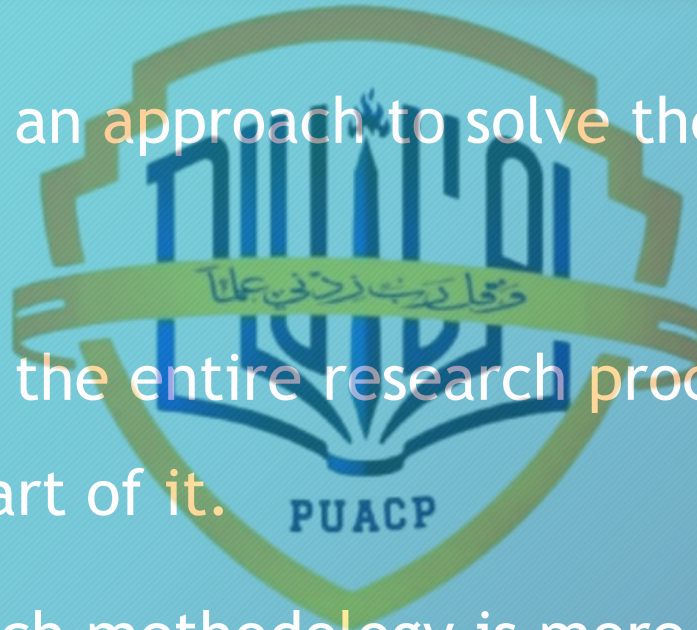
A good researcher should know the difference between research methods and methodology

Research methods

- These are the essentially planned scientific techniques and algorithms used in research.
- All the methods used by a researcher during a research study are termed as research methods.
- Research methods help us collect samples, data and find a solution to a problem.
- Research methods are useful to set up relationship between variables
- Research Methods assess the correctness of the solution.

Research Methodology

- Research Methodology is an approach to solve the research problem systematically.
- Research Methodology is the entire research process and research methods constitutes a part of it.
- The magnitude of research methodology is more than research methods.
- It is an overall plan for conducting research.



Thanks

